



FREE PORT GUIDE · ISLANDER

Margaritaville at Sea Islander from Port Tampa Bay

Western Caribbean fun from downtown Tampa: Cozumel, Progreso, Key West, Belize and Roatán. Here's how to roll into Terminal 6 like a pro.

SHIP

Margaritaville at Sea Islander

TERMINAL

Terminal 6 · 1333 McKay Street, Tampa, FL 33602

CRUISE LENGTHS

4 to 7 nights, plus select 8–10 night specials

HOMEPORT

Port Tampa Bay, Tampa, FL

DOORS CLOSE

2:30 PM (no exceptions)

NEAREST AIRPORT

Tampa Int'l (TPA), about 20 min

Getting to the port

Flying in

- **Tampa International (TPA)** is about 20 minutes away by car or rideshare.
- **St. Pete–Clearwater (PIE)** is about 35–40 minutes and often has budget-airline deals.
- **Orlando (MCO)** is about 1.5 hours east; doable if the fare savings are worth it.
- Fly in the day before so a delay can't cost you the cruise.

Driving in

- Terminal 6 is downtown on McKay Street and has its **own parking area**, separate from the main Channelside terminals. Make sure your GPS says Terminal 6!
- Use the drop-off lane: porters take your bags curbside before you park.
- Food options right by Terminal 6 are limited, so eat before you arrive.

Parking

- **Port parking** at Terminal 6 is prepaid through Port Tampa Bay's online parking portal. Rates are quoted when you enter your cruise details, and prepaying is smart on busy days.
- **Off-site lots** with shuttles can be cheaper, from just a few dollars a day. Compare reviews and shuttle times before you book.

Embarkation day, the easy way

- About 3 weeks out you'll receive your arrival window based on stateroom location. Suites and Priority guests board first.
- Print your luggage tags from Cruise Control and attach them at home.
- Have your boarding pass, original travel documents and a credit card ready at check-in.

Don't be late: Terminal 6 doors close at 2:30 PM with no exceptions. Late arrivals are denied boarding.

Before you sail: stay & play in Tampa

- **Tampa Riverwalk** is great for a stroll, a scooter ride or waterfront drinks.
- **Ybor City** offers historic cigar-town charm, Cuban sandwiches and nightlife.
- **Sparkman Wharf & Armature Works** for food halls and craft beer.
- **The Florida Aquarium** is a fun pre-cruise stop for families.

Where Islander sails

Length	Ports of call
4 nights	Cozumel
5 nights	Cozumel + Progreso
5 nights	Key West + Progreso
7 nights	Key West, Roatán (Honduras), Belize + Cozumel
8–10 nights	Select special sailings; ask us what's on the calendar

Port-of-call cheat sheet

Cozumel, Mexico

Beach clubs, world-class snorkeling and diving on the reefs, or a ferry over to Playa del Carmen.

Progreso, Mexico

Gateway to the Yucatán. Stroll the malecón, visit nearby Maya ruins at Dzibilchaltún, or take a full-day trip to Chichén Itzá (about 2 hours each way).

Key West

Bike Old Town, sip something frozen on Duval Street and catch the Mallory Square sunset.

Belize City, Belize

A tender port. Popular picks are cave tubing, zip-lining and snorkeling the barrier reef. Book early; these tours sell out.

Roatán, Honduras

Gorgeous West Bay Beach, snorkeling right off the sand and island tours with sloths and monkeys.

Margaritaville at Sea need-to-knows

- **Gratuities** are added automatically: \$22 per person, per night in staterooms; \$25 in suites.
- **Drinking age is 21** for all alcoholic beverages.
- **No outside alcohol.** Bottles bought in port are held at the gangway and returned at the end of the cruise.
- **The booking guest must be 18+.** Minors sailing without a parent need a Parental/Legal Guardian Release Form.
- **Names must match.** The name on your ID has to match your reservation exactly.
- **Original documents only.** Photocopies and phone photos of IDs are not accepted.

Embarkation-day carry-on checklist

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| ☐ Passport or birth certificate + government photo ID (originals!) | ☐ Medications and anything you can't live without |
| ☐ Printed or digital boarding pass for every guest | ☐ Phone charger & a small power bank |
| ☐ Credit card for your onboard account | ☐ Reusable water bottle |
| ☐ Luggage tags printed and attached at home | ☐ Parking confirmation or pickup details |
| ☐ Swimsuit, sunscreen & sunglasses (cabins may not be ready right away) | ☐ Flip-flops and a cover-up for pool time |

Want us to handle the details?

Our travel advisors love Margaritaville at Sea and can help you pick the right sailing and cabin, line up pre-cruise hotels and transfers, and watch for price drops, at no extra cost to you.

👉 **Plan My Cruise at cruisestoursandtravel.com** · Share your own cruise story:
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Information current as of October 2026 and gathered from Margaritaville at Sea, port authorities and cruise news sources. Ports, terminals, times, fees and itineraries change, so please confirm with the cruise line, the port and your boarding pass before you go. Drive and distance figures are approximate. The Chill Compass is an independent blog and is not affiliated with, endorsed by or sponsored by Margaritaville at Sea or Margaritaville Enterprises. All trademarks belong to their respective owners. Presented by Cruises Tours and Travel, LLC · Florida Seller of Travel Reg. No. ST150140.